

1. In this question, we will construct the tangent plane to the graph of the function

$$f(x, y) = \sin(x + y)$$

at a particular point P .

- (a) Let $P = (\pi/2, 0, c)$. For what value of c is P on the graph of f ?
- (b) In single variable calculus, how did we compute the equation of the tangent line to the graph of a function $g(x)$ at a point (x_0, y_0) ?
- (c) How can we obtain the graphs of two single variable functions that go through the point P ?
- (d) For each of these single variable functions, determine the slope of their tangent lines.
- (e) Using these slopes, find a direction vector (in $\mathbb{R}^3$) for each of these tangent lines.
- (f) Compute the parametric forms for each of these tangent lines.
- (g) What is the relationship between these tangent lines and the tangent plane to the graph of $f(x, y)$?
- (h) Use the tangent lines you computed to find a (scalar) equation for the tangent plane to the graph of f at the point P .

Takeaway: computing the tangent plane to the graph of a function $f(x, y)$ at a point $P = (x_0, y_0, f(x_0, y_0))$

We can use the tangent plane to obtain an approximation of the function $f(x, y)$ at points (x, y) close to (x_0, y_0) :

$$L(x, y) =$$

This also allows us to estimate the change in the values of f for (x, y) close to (x_0, y_0) :

Definition:

2. Estimate the volume of paint needed to cover a cylinder of height 5m and radius 1m with a coat of paint 0.01m thick. (Recall that the volume of a cylinder with radius r and height h is given by $\pi r^2 h$)